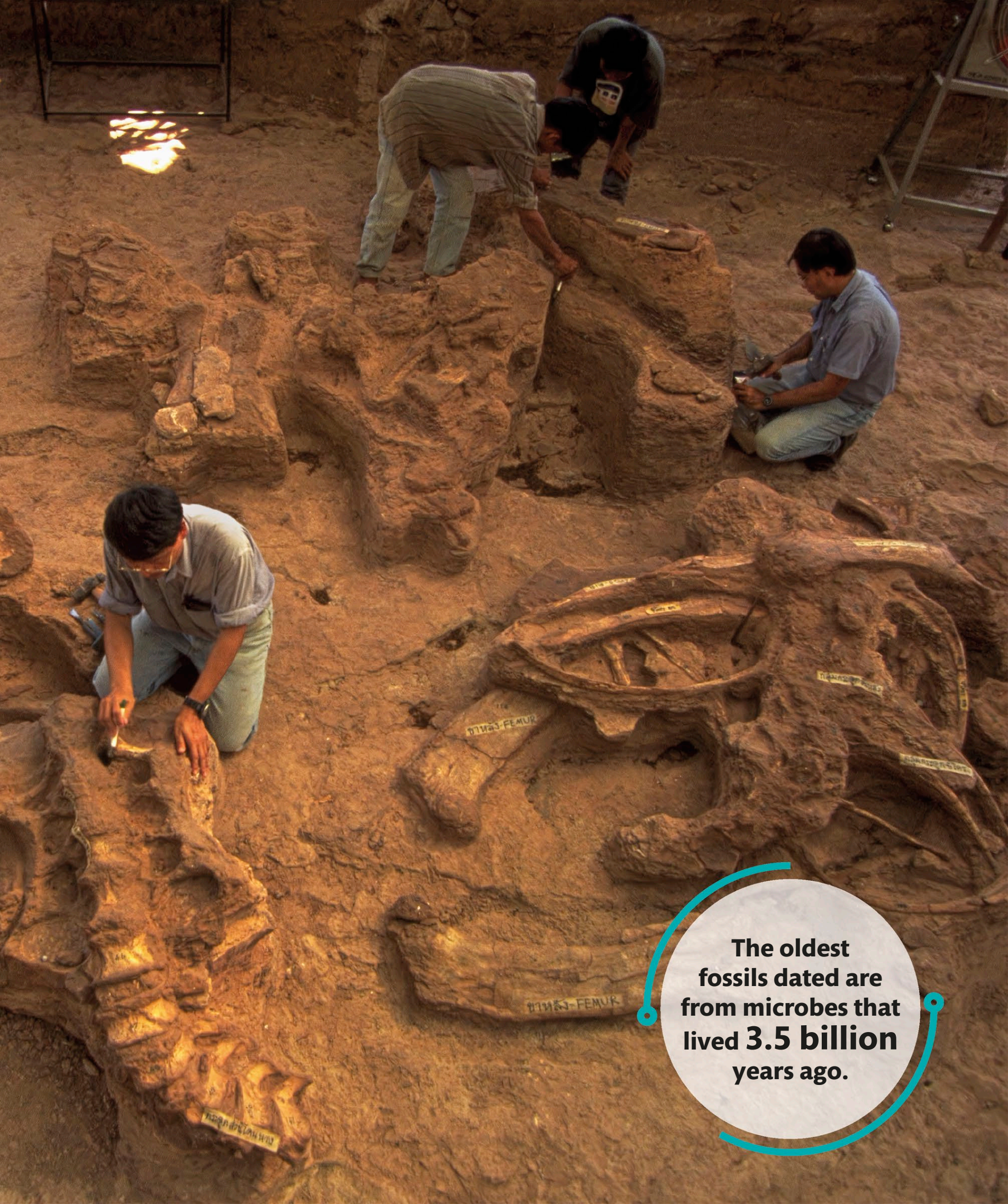




The oldest fossils dated are from microbes that lived **3.5 billion** years ago.